

1.4.3 Core technical concepts related to use of the ball

1.4.3.1 Overview

Basic technical skills

Passing
Shooting
Receiving, controlling and keeping the ball
Running with the ball
Tackling
Dribbling
Heading
Goalkeeping technique

Futsal-specific technical skills

Trapping the ball with the sole of the foot
Using the sole of the foot to play short passes
Using the sole of the foot when dribbling
Toe-pokes
Kicking with the outside of the foot
Passing with the inside of the foot
Goalkeeping technique

1.4.3.2 Passing

Passing is the best way to launch an attack, since it is the quickest and least tiring way of moving the ball from one part of the court to another, occupying space, beating one or more opponents or the defensive line, and retaining possession of the ball. Passes must be accurate, easy to control, measured and played at the right time.

Passing directly to a team-mate

Direct passes must be played to a team-mate's feet. In some situations (e.g. where there is tight marking) the pass must be made to the foot opposite to the side where the opponent is positioned, to enable the player receiving the ball to protect it as much as possible.

Pass into space

A pass into space is timed to intersect the trajectory of a team-mate's run so that the latter and the ball converge on the target space.

The optimal situation for a pass into space is when the player receiving the ball controls it without having to slow down as they run into the target space.

When should a pass into space be played and when should a pass be made directly to a team-mate's feet?

If the aim is to keep possession of the ball, passes should predominantly be made to feet, whereas when the ball needs to be played into space to launch an attack straight away, the best option is for the ball to be passed to where the receiving player is making their run.

The objectives and purpose of passing

The objectives and purposes of passing are as follows:

To develop moves: backward passes (to a team-mate behind the ball); forward passes (to a team-mate in front of the ball); cross-field passes (to spread play).

To create space: through balls (splitting the defence).

To finish moves: long balls that reach a team-mate as they make a run towards the opponents' goal, that are played in behind the defender or which put the player receiving the ball into a shooting position.

The risks associated with square passes

Square passes can be extremely dangerous, especially if they are made from the side of the court to the centre. If the ball is intercepted, it cuts out both the passer and the intended recipient. In such situations, it is up to the receiver to open up a more suitable passing angle.

1.4.3.3 Directional ball control

By 'directional ball control' we mean a player's ability to receive the ball and redirect it with the first touch according to how they want play to develop. This technical skill has become especially important when playing at a high level. In today's futsal, stopping the ball dead in the position in which it is received is no longer effective.

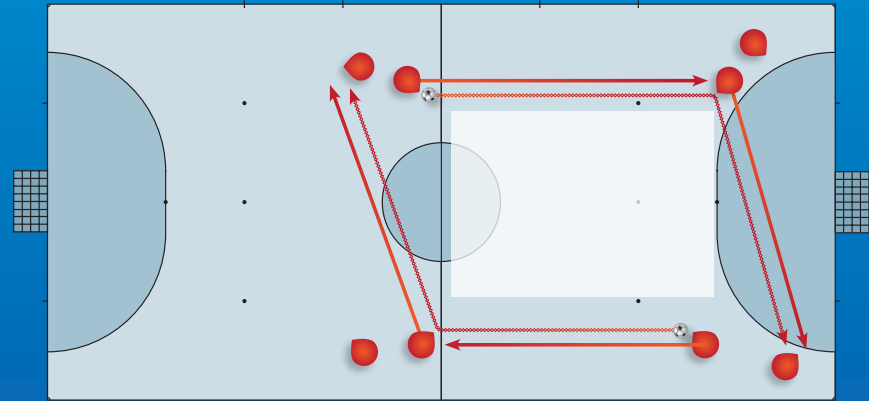
Controlling the ball while remaining aware of game development

The player with the ball often focuses completely on controlling it, and thus does not notice a team-mate who has managed to escape their marker. The ability to be aware of several things at once must be nurtured in order to develop play. This can be achieved through drills that reinforce the player's perception of the entire court.

Control and shielding of the ball

Receiving the ball well requires proficiency in terms of controlling the ball and shielding it from opponents. The player receiving possession must position their body between the opponent and the ball, and control the ball with the foot that is further away from the opponent.

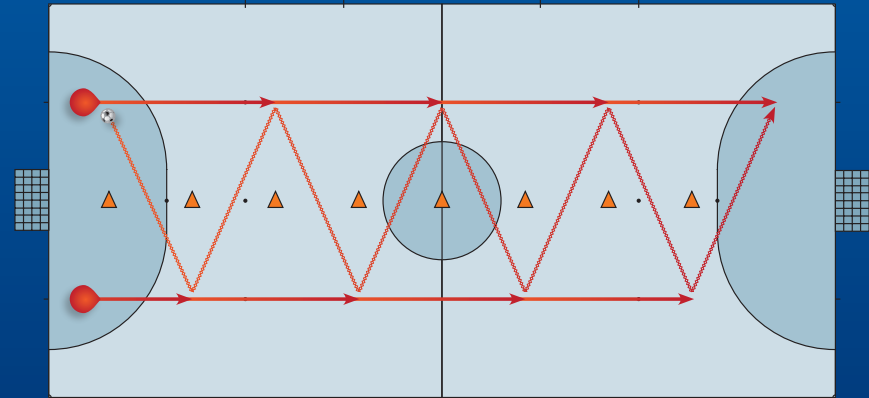
Drills and game-situation exercises for passing and receiving the ball



DRILL DESCRIPTION

Mark out a rectangle of approximately 15x12m and put two or three players at each corner, with the balls positioned as shown. The ball should be passed around the edge of the rectangle (e.g. in a clockwise direction), with players allowed two touches. The player

follows the direction of their pass and stands behind the team-mate to whom they have passed the ball. The pass should be controlled so that the ball is ready to be moved in the direction of the next pass.



DRILL DESCRIPTION

Two players stand eight-10 metres apart at one end of the court. They make their way up the court, passing the ball to each other between the cones, with first-time or second-touch passes.